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HAPPY FEET
Louboutin's red-soled shoes have an almost mythical status in popular culture, with singer J.Lo even writing a song about them

it's sunny. Whereas in New York, it's dark and windy and everyone walks everywhere, so it's more boots than sandals," he explains. Indians, he says, love gold since it matches our skin tone, and also most traditional outfits and jewellery. Also, we like brighter colours. "Pastels don't do well in India, but a strong pink which is popular here, I can't keep in a store in London or Paris," he says. "It's almost like fragrances. A particular perfume may feel too strong in a cold climate, but it may feel perfectly normal in a hot climate. Similarly, bright shoes with the brightness of India work, but they come as a bit of a shock when everything around you is light-coloured," explains Louboutin, whose red-soled shoes have an almost mythical status in popular culture. In 2009, J.Lo wrote a song 'Louboutins' in praise of them, and younger celebrities such as Zendaya and Bella Hadid are also fans of the shoes.

But how did the red soles come about? Over three decades ago, Louboutin was already making waves in the fashion industry